

Forms & Validation

Part of **Web Development Foundations** · Estimated time: 30 min

Introduction

Forms are how a page collects information from a visitor — a signup, a search box, a checkout. Getting validation right means catching obvious mistakes early without being annoying about it.

Core ideas

- HTML input types do a lot of validation for free: `type="email"` checks for an @ sign, `type="number"` restricts to digits, and the `required` attribute blocks empty submission.
- The `pattern` attribute lets you enforce a custom format with a regular expression when built-in types aren't specific enough.
- The `:invalid` CSS pseudo-class lets you style a field differently the moment its value doesn't pass validation, which is useful for real-time feedback.
- Client-side validation is about user experience, not security — a malicious user can bypass it entirely, so the server must always re-validate anything it receives.

Example

```
<form>
  <input type="email" required placeholder="you@example.com">
  <button type="submit">Sign up</button>
</form>
```

Try it yourself

Build a small signup form with a name field (required), an email field (`type="email"`, required), and a password field (`minlength="8"`). Try submitting it empty and with an invalid email to see the browser's built-in error messages.

Further reading

- [MDN — Learn Forms](https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn/Forms)

<https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn/Forms>

- [MDN — Client-side Form Validation](https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Learn/Forms/Form_validation)

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